

Robots at work

Fukushima nuclear reactor is now being explored by bots as the radiation levels are too high for humans

How to be a YouTube celebrity?

Always fancied having a trending channel on YouTube? Well here's your chance to learn the trade secrets. Watch the video here <http://bbc.in/g3T17c>

WINDOWS PHONE 7

the **GOOD** the **BAD** and the **UNKNOWN**

The smartphone battleground has seen a new entrant with Microsoft promising to put up a brave fight with Windows Phone 7. Is it time for you to switch camps?

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Microsoft's latest smartphone platform – Windows Phone 7 has been in the news for its fresh, ground-up approach, garnering a fairly positive initial feedback from most analysts across the globe. Windows Phone 7 is definitely good news for the touch screen smartphone market. There's a significant third choice along with the popular Apple iOS and the rapidly growing Android platform. Coming from the Microsoft stable, Windows Phone 7 certainly does enjoy a certain level of trust and familiarity in the Indian market.

As a standalone smartphone OS, Windows Phone 7 seems impressive and is miles ahead of the earlier Windows Mobile platform. But, when compared to the Android and the Apple iOS, WP7 (in its current form) has its fair share of limitations, issues and restrictions. Given the fact that the WP7 is comparatively a fairly young platform

holding a “work-in-progress” placard, one can ignore some of the obvious omissions and niggles that are expected to get ironed out via updates. It is the overall philosophy and approach that one needs to keep in mind to evaluate it against the competing smartphone platforms.

THE GOOD

Not exactly an “app centric” approach

Unlike the Android and iOS platforms, Windows Phone 7 keeps away from the app centric interface for its home screen. You get a “tiled” interface. These tiles are a

lot larger on the screen; this allows for easier operation owing to the larger surface area of each tile. Another significant advantage is that each tile is “live” and displays latest information and updates without having to enter the application. For example, one glance on the home screen will update you about your latest mailbox activity, Facebook updates and last accessed office documents. Microsoft believes that the tiled interface ensures that the user

spends less time on the phone and gets the information quicker.

Surely, we found the tiled interface a lot more convenient and practical. While the home screen is not laced with apps, one does ultimately deal with them once you get into the main menu that lists all the apps. You can create a tile for any app and bring it to the home screen.

WP7 groups related content and information under “Hubs”. Content is segregated across six hubs – People, Music,

The “Hubs” display images of the people with whom you interact regularly, a very fresh feel compared to the icon laden interface of the iPhone and Android platforms



Pictures, Games, Marketplace and Office. The “people” hub clubs your phone contact list, Facebook friends list and email contacts together. In the same fashion, relevant content is grouped across the six hubs in an easy to find and use manner.

Fluidity that rivals the iOS

When it comes to the touchscreen response and behaviour, WP7 is at least as good as the iOS and certainly better